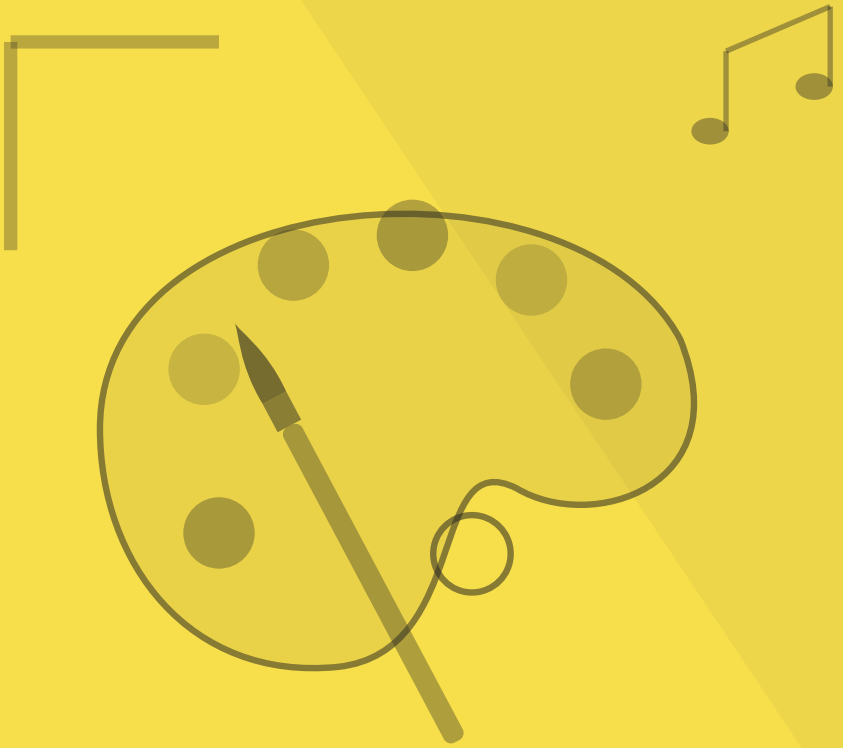
VENVLEARNING

TEACHER EDITION



Art

GRADE 7

Guided lessons, pacing, and complete answer keys

2026–2027 School Year · Unit 1: The Elements of Art

VENVLEARNING

Grade 7
Art

TEACHER EDITION

2026–2027 School Year

Unit 1 The Elements of Art

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this Teacher Edition

This book holds everything needed to teach the course: unit overviews, a plan for every lesson with what to say and do, the student lesson with Try It answers, and answer keys for every workbook page, weekly check and unit test.

- Daily routine (about 45–55 minutes): Look and Talk 5 · Learn and Demonstrate 10 · Create 25 · Reflect 5.
- Say: lines are a suggested script. Use your own words.
- Monday and Wednesday are lessons. Friday is the Sketchbook Check (about 15 minutes), then corrections or a project.
- Dates match the VenvLearning lesson plans for the 2026–2027 school year.

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UNIT 1 · TEACHER OVERVIEW

The Elements of Art

Critique, line and mark-making, form and light, proportion, color schemes, chiaroscuro, composition, and the artist statement.

Skilled artists combine sharp eyes with deliberate choices. In this unit you'll learn a professional critique method, build drawing skills (mark-making, light logic, proportion), use color theory and dramatic value, plan strong compositions, and finish a revised work with an artist statement.

Big ideas

- Critique art using describe, analyze, interpret, judge.
- Use contour, gesture, and value techniques; render light on forms.
- Apply proportion, color schemes, and chiaroscuro.
- Plan compositions, revise with critique, and write an artist statement.

Standards

Code	Standard
NCAS VA:Cr1–3	Generate, develop, and refine artwork.
NCAS VA:Pr5	Prepare work for presentation.
NCAS VA:Re7–9	Perceive, interpret, and evaluate.
NCAS VA:Cn11	Relate art to context.

What students should already know

- Grade 6 art basics.

Materials for the unit

- Sketchbook; graded pencils (2H, HB, 4B); fine pens; charcoal
- Color media

- Flashlight or lamp
- Measuring tape and mirror
- Portfolio folder

Pacing calendar

Week	Day	Lesson	Title
Week of Oct 26	Wed 10/28	1.1	Looking Closely: The Four-Step Critique
Week of Nov 2	Mon 11/2	1.2	Line and Mark-Making
Week of Nov 2	Wed 11/4	1.3	Form and Light
Week of Nov 2	Fri 11/6	Check	Sketchbook Check 1: Critique and Line
Week of Nov 9	Mon 11/9	1.4	Proportion and the Human Figure
Week of Nov 9	Wed 11/11	1.5	Color Theory and Color Schemes
Week of Nov 9	Fri 11/13	Check	Sketchbook Check 2: Light and Proportion
Week of Nov 16	Mon 11/16	1.6	Value, Contrast, and Chiaroscuro
Week of Nov 16	Wed 11/18	1.7	Composition: Thirds, Leading Lines, and Balance
Week of Nov 16	Fri 11/20	Check	Sketchbook Check 3: Color and Value
Week of Nov 30	Mon 11/30	1.8	Revision, Critique, and the Artist Statement
Week of Nov 30	Fri 12/4	Test	Unit 1 Portfolio Review

TEACHING THIS UNIT AT HOME

Look at The Migration Series together online and talk about how it connects to the Harlem Renaissance reading in ELA.

UNIT VOCABULARY

critique	Structured discussion of art.
hatching	Parallel lines for value.
chiaroscuro	Strong light-dark contrast.
analogous	Neighboring colors.
rule of thirds	Placing key elements on thirds.
artist statement	Explanation of an artwork.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.1 · NCAS VA:Re7, VA:Re8, VA:Re9 · Wed Oct 28

Lesson 1.1: Looking Closely: The Four-Step Critique

I can analyze an artwork using describe, analyze, interpret, and judge.

Objective	Students apply the four-step critique.
Standard	NCAS VA:Re7, VA:Re8, VA:Re9 — Perceive, interpret, and evaluate artwork.
Date	Wed Oct 28
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Online access to The Migration Series, sketchbooks, workbook Lesson 1.1
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Can art opinions use evidence?
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Introduce the elements and principles. Model a four-step critique on one panel.
Create	25	Critique Practice.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Jumping to judgment.
- Describing with interpretations (“sad”) instead of facts.

SUPPORT	EXTEND
• Sentence frames for each step.	• Compare two panels' compositions.

STUDENT LESSON 1.1 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.1: Looking Closely: The Four-Step Critique

LOOK AND WONDER

Why do people disagree about whether an artwork is “good”? Can an opinion about art be supported with evidence?

Art critic Edmund Feldman described a four-step method that moves from facts to opinions, so judgments rest on evidence:

Describe: what do you see? (facts only) → Analyze: how are the elements and principles used? → Interpret: what does it mean or express? → Judge: is it successful? Why?

Practice on The Migration Series (1940–41) by Jacob Lawrence, a set of 60 small paintings about the Great Migration of African Americans from the rural South to Northern cities, the same history you read about in ELA. Lawrence used a limited palette of bold, flat colors and repeated shapes, so the whole series reads like one story. Many panels can be viewed online through the Phillips Collection and the Museum of Modern Art, which each own half of the series.

STEP BY STEP · CRITIQUE ONE PANEL

Choose any panel from The Migration Series.

1. Describe: list figures, objects, colors, and words in the caption.
2. Analyze: find repeated shapes, strong diagonals, or the limited color palette.
3. Interpret: what feeling or message does the panel express about the migration?
4. Judge: does it communicate that message well? Give evidence from steps 1–3.

Look for: A judgment that grows from description and analysis is persuasive, even if others disagree.

CREATE · CRITIQUE PRACTICE

Can you support an opinion about art with evidence?

You need: internet access or an art book; sketchbook.

1. Choose one Migration Series panel.
2. Write two sentences for each critique step.
3. Make a quick thumbnail sketch of the panel's composition (just the main shapes).

Record: your four-step critique and thumbnail.

KEY IDEA

Describe, analyze, interpret, judge: build opinions about art on evidence.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Which critique step lists facts only?

Answer: describe

2. Which step explains meaning?

Answer: interpret

3. What did The Migration Series depict?

Answer: the Great Migration of African Americans from the South to Northern cities

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.1.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.1

#	Question	Answer
1	A structured discussion of art	critique
2	Name two principles of design.	e.g. balance, contrast, emphasis, rhythm
3	Write your four-step critique of one Migration Series panel.	Answers vary; each step must be present and judgments supported by evidence.
4	Thumbnail of the panel's main shapes.	Simplified composition sketch.
5	Why does the critique save “judge” for last?	So the opinion is based on careful looking and analysis instead of a first impression.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.2 · NCAS VA:Cr2 · Mon Nov 2

Lesson 1.2: Line and Mark-Making

I can use contour, gesture, hatching, cross-hatching, and stippling to describe form and value.

Objective	Students use line techniques for form and value.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr2 — Organize and develop artistic work.
Date	Mon Nov 2
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Fine pens, pencils, sketchbooks, workbook Lesson 1.2
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Black lines showing light?
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Demonstrate each mark-making technique.
Create	25	Mark-Making Value Studies.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Uneven spacing that makes muddy values.

SUPPORT

- Practice strips with guide lines.

EXTEND

- Make a stippled portrait of a pet.

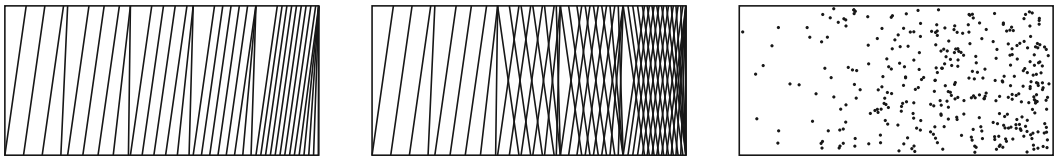
STUDENT LESSON 1.2 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.2: Line and Mark-Making

LOOK AND WONDER

How can a drawing made only of black lines show light and shadow?

Line can describe edges, movement, and even value. A contour line traces edges slowly. A blind contour, drawn without looking at the paper, trains your eye to see. A gesture drawing captures movement in seconds. To build value with line, artists use hatching, cross-hatching, and stippling.



hatching cross-hatching stippling

The German artist Albrecht Dürer (1471–1528) was a master of hatching in engravings and woodcuts. In his woodcut Rhinoceros (1515), patterns of lines create both texture and value, even though Dürer never saw the animal; he worked from a written description and a sketch by someone else.

CREATE · MARK-MAKING VALUE STUDIES

Which technique makes the smoothest value change?

You need: fine black pen or sharp pencil; sketchbook.

1. Draw three rectangles divided into five boxes.
2. Fill one with hatching, one with cross-hatching, and one with stippling, light to dark.
3. Draw a 2-minute blind contour of your hand.
4. Draw your hand again, looking, and shade it with one technique.

Record: the three value strips and two hand drawings.

KEY IDEA

Line can describe edges (contour), movement (gesture), and value (hatching, cross-hatching, stippling).

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. What is hatching?

Answer: parallel lines that create value

2. Which technique uses dots?

Answer: stippling

3. Why do blind contours?

Answer: to train your eye to look closely at edges

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.2.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.2

#	Question	Answer
1	Quick drawing of movement	gesture
2	Layered hatching in different directions	cross-hatching
3	Three value strips: hatching, cross-hatching, stippling (5 steps each).	Even steps from light to dark in all three.
4	Shaded hand drawing.	Accurate contour; value with one technique.
5	Which technique would best show rough tree bark? Why?	Cross-hatching or hatching that follows the bark's direction shows rough texture and dark grooves.

SKETCHBOOK CHECK · Fri Nov 6

Sketchbook Check 1: Critique and Line — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	The four critique steps in order	describe, analyze, interpret, judge
2	Parallel lines that create value	hatching
3	A quick drawing of movement	gesture
4	Make three boxes of value: hatching, cross-hatching, stippling.	Three techniques shown clearly.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.3 · NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Cr3 · Wed Nov 4

Lesson 1.3: Form and Light

I can render a form using a consistent light source with highlight, midtone, core shadow, reflected light, and cast shadow.

Objective	Students render forms with consistent light.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Cr3 — Develop and refine artistic work.
Date	Wed Nov 4
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Objects, lamp, graded pencils, blending tools, workbook Lesson 1.3
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Flashlight and ball.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Demonstrate the five parts of light on a sphere.
Create	25	Still Life with One Light.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Outlining forms with dark lines; shading the edge evenly.

SUPPORT

- Value finder: a card with a hole.

EXTEND

- Render an egg on white paper (white on white).

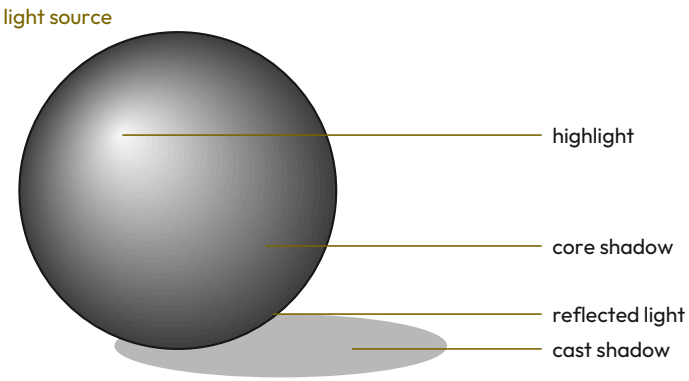
STUDENT LESSON 1.3 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.3: Form and Light

LOOK AND WONDER

Shine a flashlight on a ball in a dark room. Where is it brightest? Where is it darkest? Is the edge of the shadow side completely black?

Realistic drawing depends on light logic: every form in a picture is lit from the same direction. On a sphere, value changes gradually from the highlight through the midtones to the core shadow. Near the edge of the shadow side, light bounces back from the table as reflected light. The darkest dark is usually the cast shadow right where the object touches the surface.



CREATE · STILL LIFE WITH ONE LIGHT

Can you render three forms lit the same way?

You need: a ball, a box, and a can or cup; flashlight or desk lamp; pencils (2H, HB, 4B if you have them); blending stump or tissue.

1. Arrange the objects and light them from one side in a dim room.
2. Lightly draw their shapes and the cast shadows.
3. Squint to see the value groups; shade from light to dark.
4. Check: is the light coming from the same side on every object?

Record: your rendered still life with the light direction marked by an arrow.

KEY IDEA

Keep one light source. Render highlight, midtone, core shadow, reflected light, and cast shadow.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Where is the darkest part of a cast shadow?

Answer: where the object touches the surface

2. Why is reflected light dimmer than the lit side?

Answer: it's bounced light, not direct light

3. What goes wrong with two light directions?

Answer: the forms look flat or confusing

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.3.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.3

#	Question	Answer
1	Brightest spot	highlight
2	Shadow thrown onto the table	cast shadow
3	Render a sphere and a cube lit from the upper right. Label the five parts of light on the sphere.	Consistent light source; five labeled parts.
4	Why do artists squint at their subject?	Squinting blurs detail and makes the big value groups easier to see.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.4 · NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Cn11 · Mon Nov 9

Lesson 1.4: Proportion and the Human Figure

I can use proportion guidelines to draw a face and a standing figure.

Objective	Students apply proportion guidelines.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Cn11 — Develop artistic work; relate art to cultural and historical context.
Date	Mon Nov 9
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Measuring tapes, mirrors, pencils, workbook Lesson 1.4
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Heads tall?
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Show the Vitruvian Man; demonstrate face and figure guides.
Create	25	Measured Portrait and Figure.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Drawing eyes too high; heads too large on figures.

SUPPORT

- Pre-marked figure templates.

EXTEND

- Draw a figure in action with foreshortening.

STUDENT LESSON 1.4 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.4: Proportion and the Human Figure

LOOK AND WONDER

How many of your head-heights tall do you think you are? Guess, then measure with a partner.

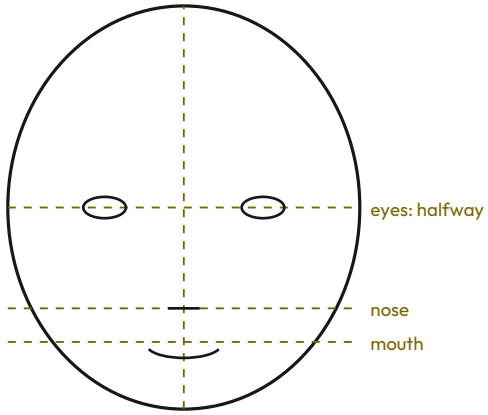
Artists have measured the body for thousands of years. Around 1490, Leonardo da Vinci drew the Vitruvian Man, a figure inside a circle and a square, based on the Roman architect Vitruvius's ideas about ideal proportions. Today artists often use the head as a unit: an adult is roughly 7½ heads tall (fashion and comic illustrators often stretch it to 8 or more).

On the face, the eyes sit about halfway down the head.

The bottom of the nose is about halfway between the eyes and the chin; the mouth is about a third of the way from nose to chin.

The tops of the ears line up with the brow; the bottoms with the nose.

On the body, the hips are near the halfway point, and the fingertips reach mid-thigh.



CREATE · MEASURED PORTRAIT AND FIGURE

Do proportion rules match real people?

You need: pencil; measuring tape; mirror; a partner or a photo.

1. Measure a partner's head height and total height; divide to find “heads tall.”
2. Draw a proportional face with guidelines from the mirror.
3. Draw a standing figure 7½ heads tall using stacked ovals as a guide.
4. Compare the rule with your measurements.

Record: measurements, the face, and the figure.

KEY IDEA

Use the head as a unit: eyes halfway down the head, an adult about 7½ heads tall. Measure real people to test the rules.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. About how many heads tall is an adult?

Answer: about 7½

2. Who drew the Vitruvian Man?

Answer: Leonardo da Vinci

3. Where do the ears line up?

Answer: between the brow and the bottom of the nose

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.4.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.4

#	Question	Answer
1	Rules for ideal proportions	canon of proportion
2	Eyes are about ___ down the head.	halfway
3	Partner's head height (cm)	Answers vary.
4	Partner's total height ÷ head height =	Answers vary (about 6.5–7.5 for teens).
5	Proportional figure, 7½ heads tall, with head-unit marks.	Correct head units; hips near middle.
6	Why might a teen measure fewer “heads tall” than an adult?	Heads are proportionally larger in younger people; bodies grow more than heads.

SKETCHBOOK CHECK · Fri Nov 13

Sketchbook Check 2: Light and Proportion — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Name the five parts of light on a sphere.	highlight, midtone, core shadow, reflected light, cast shadow
2	An adult is about how many heads tall?	7½
3	Render a sphere with a light source from the left.	Consistent shading and cast shadow to the right.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.5 · NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re8 · Wed Nov 11

Lesson 1.5: Color Theory and Color Schemes

I can describe hue, saturation, and value, and use color schemes to create mood.

Objective	Students apply color theory and schemes.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re8 — Develop artistic work; interpret meaning.
Date	Wed Nov 11
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Color media, workbook Lesson 1.5
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Warm sunsets, calm oceans.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Teach hue/value/saturation; demonstrate desaturating with a complement.
Create	25	One Image, Two Moods.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Confusing analogous and complementary.

SUPPORT

- Color wheel to point at while choosing.

EXTEND

- Find each scheme in film posters.

STUDENT LESSON 1.5 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.5: Color Theory and Color Schemes

LOOK AND WONDER

Why do sunsets feel warm and oceans feel calm? Is it the color, or what we associate with it?

Every color has three properties: hue (its name), value (light or dark), and saturation (bright or dull). Mixing a color with its complement lowers saturation, making it duller or grayer. Artists choose color schemes to set a mood.



Blue and orange are complements: opposite on the wheel.

Scheme	Colors	Effect
monochromatic	tints and shades of one hue	unified, calm
analogous	3–4 neighbors (yellow, yellow-green, green)	harmonious, natural
complementary	opposites (blue and orange)	high contrast, energetic
split-complementary	one hue + the two neighbors of its complement	contrast with less tension
triadic	three evenly spaced hues (red, yellow, blue)	lively, balanced
warm / cool	reds, oranges, yellows / blues, greens, violets	warm advances; cool recedes

CREATE · ONE IMAGE, TWO MOODS

How does a color scheme change meaning?

You need: colored pencils, markers, or paint; two copies of a simple line drawing.

1 Draw a simple scene (a house and tree) and trace it twice.

2 Color one in an analogous warm scheme.

3 Color the other in a complementary or cool scheme.

4 Write the mood of each.

Record: both versions and a sentence about how mood changed.

KEY IDEA

Hue, value, and saturation describe any color. Color schemes control harmony, contrast, and mood.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Complement of red

Answer: green

2. Analogous colors are...

Answer: neighbors on the wheel

3. How do you lower a color's saturation?

Answer: mix in its complement (or gray)

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.5.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.5

#	Question	Answer
1	A color's name	hue
2	Brightness or dullness of a color	saturation
3	Triad including red	red, yellow, blue
4	Split-complement of blue	blue with yellow-orange and red-orange
5	Analogous to violet	e.g. red-violet, violet, blue-violet
6	Do warm colors seem to advance or recede?	advance
7	Your scene in two color schemes (side by side).	Correct schemes and a stated mood for each.
8	Which scheme would you use for a poster about a calm library? Why?	Analogous cool or monochromatic blue: harmonious and calm.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.6 · NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re7 · Mon Nov 16

Lesson 1.6: Value, Contrast, and Chiaroscuro

I can make a nine-step value scale and use strong contrast (chiaroscuro) for drama.

Objective	Students control value and use chiaroscuro.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re7 — Develop artistic work; perceive and analyze.
Date	Mon Nov 16
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Flashlights, objects, charcoal or pencils, workbook Lesson 1.6
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Lighting in movies.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Demonstrate a 9-step scale. Discuss Caravaggio and Rembrandt.
Create	25	Dramatic Light Study.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Not going dark enough.

SUPPORT

- Value finder card.

EXTEND

- Photograph a still life in dramatic light and draw from the photo.

STUDENT LESSON 1.6 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.6: Value, Contrast, and Chiaroscuro

LOOK AND WONDER

Watch a scary movie scene with the sound off. How does lighting create the mood?

A value scale is a ruler for darkness. Artists train by making even steps from white to black, then use that control to model forms.



white black

Italian painters of the Renaissance and Baroque periods used chiaroscuro to make figures look solid and dramatic. Caravaggio (1571–1610) pushed it to extremes, called tenebrism: in The Calling of Saint Matthew (about 1600), a beam of light cuts across a dark room and lands on the faces of the men at the table. Rembrandt later used warm, glowing light against deep shadow in his portraits.

CREATE · DRAMATIC LIGHT STUDY

How does strong side lighting change an object?

You need: one object (a mug, an apple, a toy); flashlight; dark paper and white charcoal or chalk, or pencil on white paper.

1. Make a nine-step value scale.
2. Light your object from one low side in a dark room.
3. Draw it, pushing the darks very dark and saving the lights.
4. Compare with a drawing of the same object in flat, even light.

Record: value scale and both drawings.

KEY IDEA

Control value with even steps; strong light-dark contrast (chiaroscuro) creates drama and solidity.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. What does chiaroscuro mean?

Answer: light-dark

2. Which artist is known for tenebrism?

Answer: Caravaggio

3. How many steps in the class value scale?

Answer: nine

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.6.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.6

#	Question	Answer
1	Even steps from white to black	value scale
2	Extreme chiaroscuro	tenebrism
3	Nine-step value scale.	Nine even, distinct steps.
4	Dramatic light study of one object.	Strong contrast; clear light direction.
5	How would The Calling of Saint Matthew feel different with even lighting?	Less dramatic; the moment of being called would lose emphasis.

SKETCHBOOK CHECK · Fri Nov 20

Sketchbook Check 3: Color and Value — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Complement of yellow	violet
2	Three colors evenly spaced on the wheel	triadic
3	Italian for light-dark	chiaroscuro
4	How to dull (desaturate) a color	mix in its complement
5	Nine-step value scale.	Nine even steps.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.7 · NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cr2 · Wed Nov 18

Lesson 1.7: Composition: Thirds, Leading Lines, and Balance

I can plan a composition using the rule of thirds, leading lines, emphasis, and asymmetrical balance.

Objective	Students plan compositions with design strategies.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cr2 — Generate and organize artistic ideas.
Date	Wed Nov 18
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Sketchbooks, workbook Lesson 1.7
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Movie posters.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Analyze The Great Wave's composition.
Create	25	Four Thumbnails.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Detail-heavy thumbnails.

SUPPORT

- Thumbnail frames pre-drawn at 2 × 3 inches.

EXTEND

- Re-crop a photo three ways to change the focal point.

STUDENT LESSON 1.7 · WITH ANSWERS

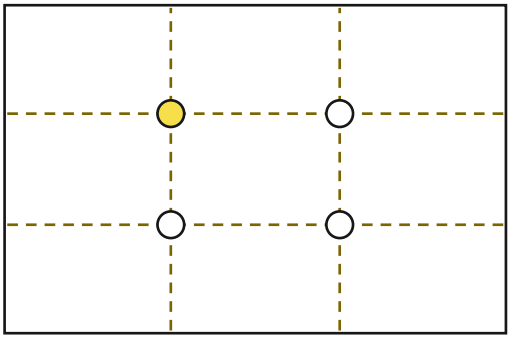
Lesson 1.7: Composition: Thirds, Leading Lines, and Balance

LOOK AND WONDER

Where does your eye go first in a movie poster? What tricks get it there?

Strong compositions guide the viewer. The rule of thirds places the focal point near one of four crossing points instead of dead center.

Leading lines (roads, rivers, arms, edges) point the eye to it. Asymmetrical balance keeps the picture interesting, and negative space gives the subject room to breathe.



In The Great Wave off Kanagawa (about 1831), Katsushika Hokusai builds a powerful asymmetrical composition: the giant wave fills the left and top, its claw-like crest leads the eye across to tiny Mount Fuji, and the boats curve along the wave's path. The small mountain balances the huge wave.

CREATE · FOUR THUMBNAILS

Which composition tells your idea best?

You need: pencil; sketchbook.

1. Choose a subject that matters to you.
2. Draw four thumbnails: centered, rule of thirds, strong leading lines, and lots of negative space.
3. Shade each in three values (light, middle, dark) only.
4. Pick the strongest and write why.

Record: four value thumbnails and your choice.

KEY IDEA

Place the focal point thoughtfully, lead the eye to it, balance asymmetrically, and use negative space.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. What are leading lines?

Answer: lines that guide the eye to the focal point

2. What balances the great wave in Hokusai's print?

Answer: small Mount Fuji (and the boats)

3. Why value-only thumbnails?

Answer: to test the composition's light-dark pattern before color

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.7.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.7

#	Question	Answer
1	Empty space around objects	negative space
2	Different elements with even visual weight	asymmetrical balance
3	Four value thumbnails of one subject; circle the strongest.	Four distinct compositions with three values each; reasoned choice.
4	Find leading lines in a photo you've taken or a poster. Describe them.	Answers vary.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.8 · NCAS VA:Cr3, VA:Pr5, VA:Re9 · Mon Nov 30

Lesson 1.8: Revision, Critique, and the Artist Statement

I can revise a work using peer critique and write an artist statement explaining my choices.

Objective	Students revise with critique and write artist statements.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr3, VA:Pr5, VA:Re9 — Refine work; present and evaluate.
Date	Mon Nov 30
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Drawing materials, workbook Lesson 1.8, Unit 1 Review
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Museum labels.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Model a critique and a statement.
Create	25	Final Piece and Statement.
Reflect	5	Share statements; Friday: Unit 1 Portfolio Review.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Statements that only describe, without choices or meaning.

SUPPORT

- Statement template.

EXTEND

- Display the work at home with its statement.

STUDENT LESSON 1.8 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.8: Revision, Critique, and the Artist Statement

LOOK AND WONDER

Have you ever read the small card next to a painting in a museum? What makes one interesting to read?

Develop your best thumbnail into a finished piece. Midway, hold a short critique using three prompts: I notice… (description), I wonder… (a question), What if… (a suggestion). Then revise.

Finish with an artist statement of 75–150 words: what you made, the elements and principles you used and why, what you changed after feedback, and what you want viewers to feel or think.

STEP BY STEP · ARTIST STATEMENT STARTER

A charcoal drawing of a grandmother's hands

1. What: “This charcoal drawing shows my grandmother's hands holding a quilt square.”
2. How: “I used chiaroscuro and a rule-of-thirds composition, with the quilt's lines leading to her hands.”
3. Revision: “After feedback, I darkened the background so the hands stand out.”
4. Meaning: “I want viewers to see how hands carry family stories.”

Look for: Clear, specific, and personal.

CREATE · FINAL PIECE AND STATEMENT

Can you finish, critique, revise, and explain a work?

You need: your chosen thumbnail; drawing paper; your choice of media.

1. Develop the thumbnail into a final work.
2. Hold a critique with I notice / I wonder / What if.
3. Revise.
4. Write your artist statement.

Record: your final piece and statement for the portfolio.

KEY IDEA

Critique with I notice / I wonder / What if; revise; explain your choices in an artist statement.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Name the three critique prompts.

Answer: I notice, I wonder, What if

2. How long is the artist statement?

Answer: about 75–150 words

3. Name two things an artist statement includes.

Answer: what you made, your choices and why, revisions, intended meaning

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.8.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.8

#	Question	Answer
1	Text explaining an artist's work	artist statement
2	Prompt for a suggestion	What if…
3	Record the feedback you received (I notice / I wonder / What if) and what you will revise.	Answers vary.
4	Write your artist statement (75–150 words).	Includes what, how, revision, and meaning.

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Dec 3 (homework) or as needed

Unit 1 Review — Answer Key

Use as a study session or portfolio sort before the review.

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	saturation	intensity of a color
2	analogous	neighboring colors
3	tenebrism	extreme chiaroscuro
4	leading lines	lines guiding the eye
5	cast shadow	shadow thrown onto a surface
6	artist statement	text explaining your work
7	Choose three Unit 1 works for your portfolio and write one sentence about each.	Answers vary.

PORTFOLIO REVIEW · Fri Dec 4

Unit 1 Portfolio Review — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Which critique step explains meaning? A. describe B. analyze C. interpret D. judge	C. interpret
2	Which scheme uses colors opposite each other? A. analogous B. complementary C. monochromatic	B. complementary
3	Where is the darkest value of a cast shadow?	where the object meets the surface
4	Name one mark-making technique for value.	hatching, cross-hatching, or stippling
5	Who painted The Calling of Saint Matthew?	Caravaggio
6	What balances the wave in Hokusai's print?	Mount Fuji (and the boats)
7	Write a four-step critique of an artwork you didn't study in this unit (any museum website).	Rubric: describe with facts (1); analyze elements/principles (1); interpret with evidence (1); judge with reasons (1).
8	Your teacher scores your Lesson 1.8 final piece and statement with this rubric. Note one goal for Unit 2.	Rubric (1 point each): planned composition; consistent light/value; purposeful color or value scheme; skilled mark-making; evidence of revision; clear artist statement.

Scoring

Score	What it means / next step
14–16 (85%+)	Excellent: skilled, purposeful, and well explained.
12–13	Solid: strengthen one technique.
Below 12	Redo one studio activity with support.

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